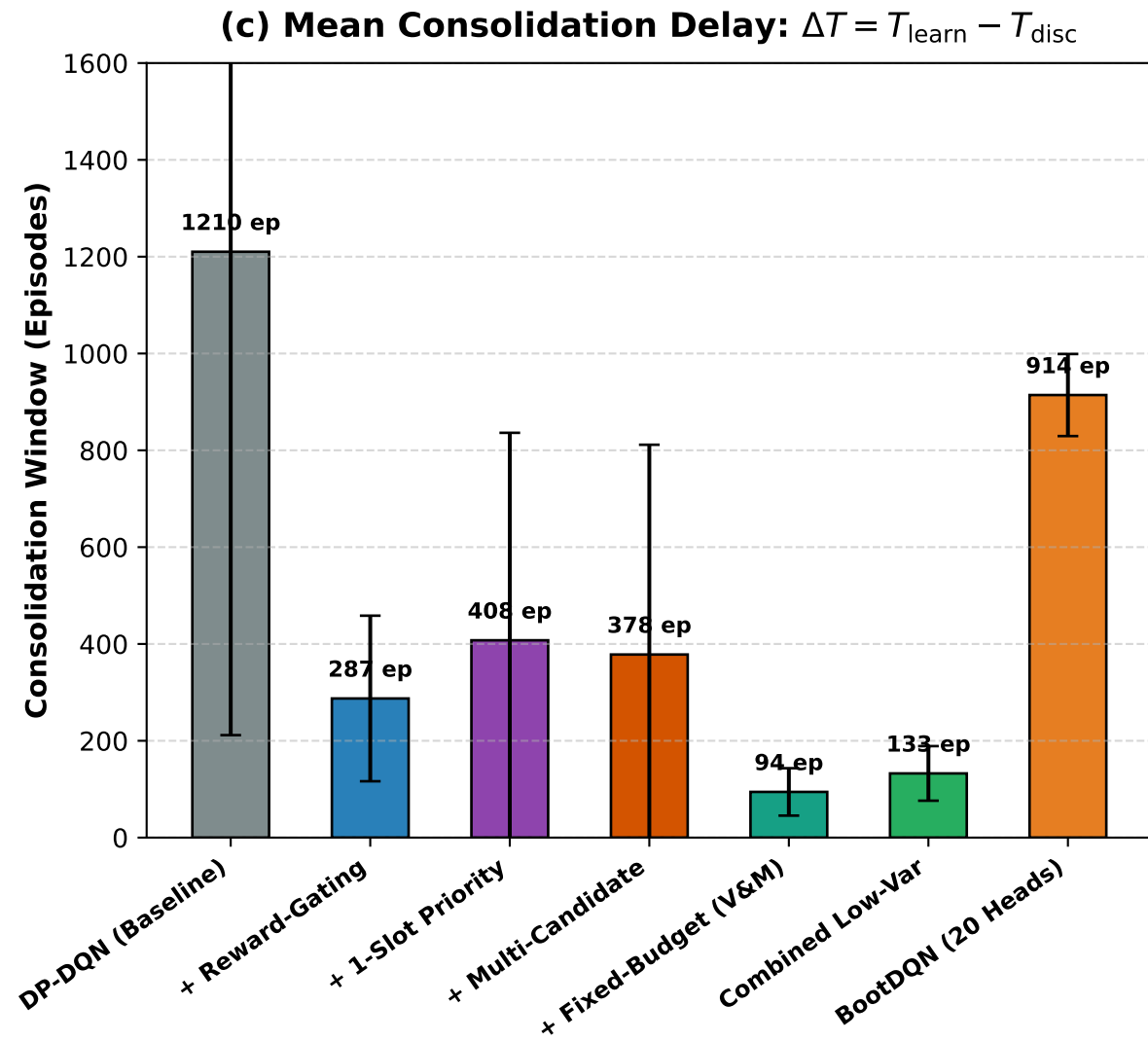
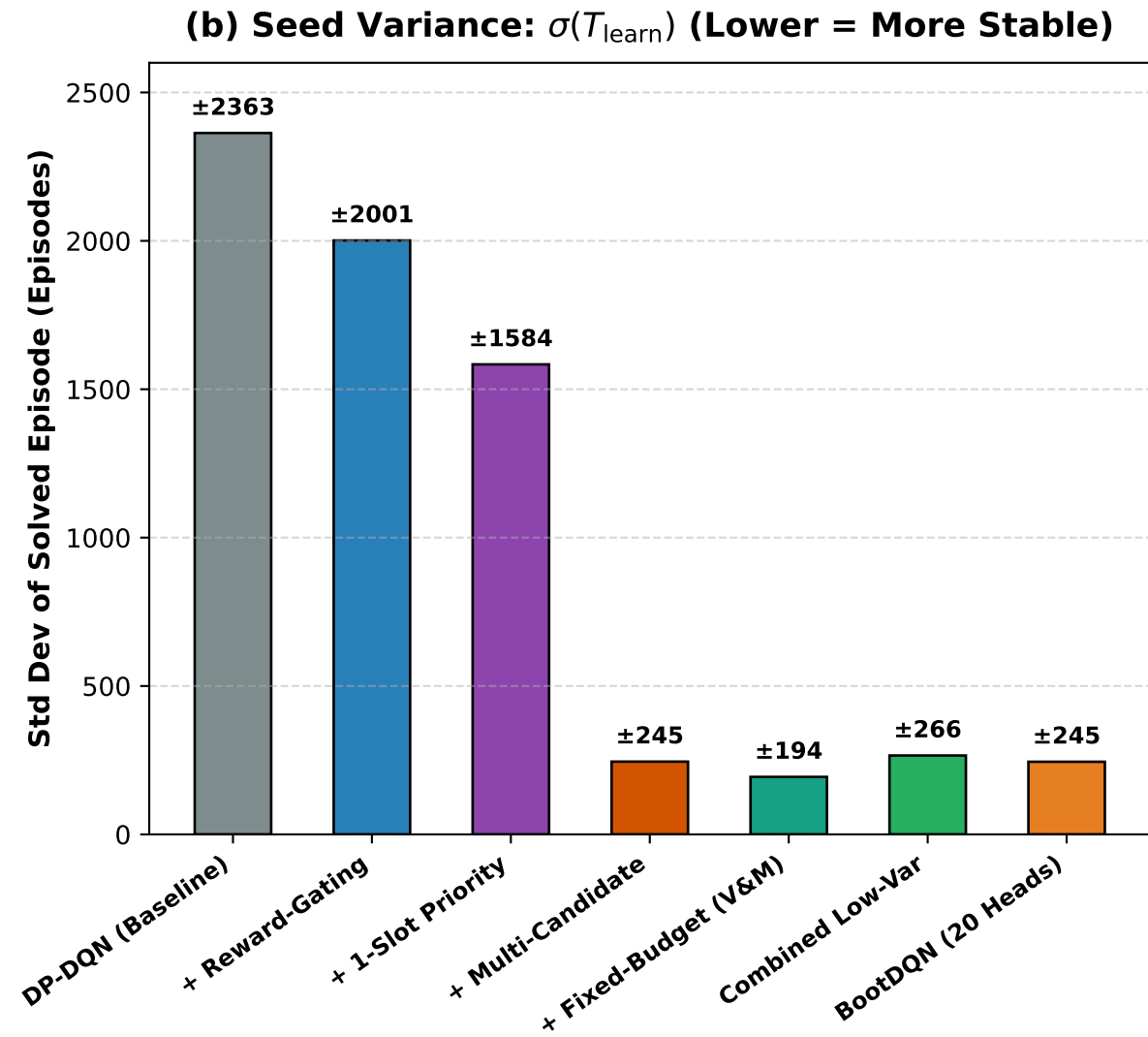
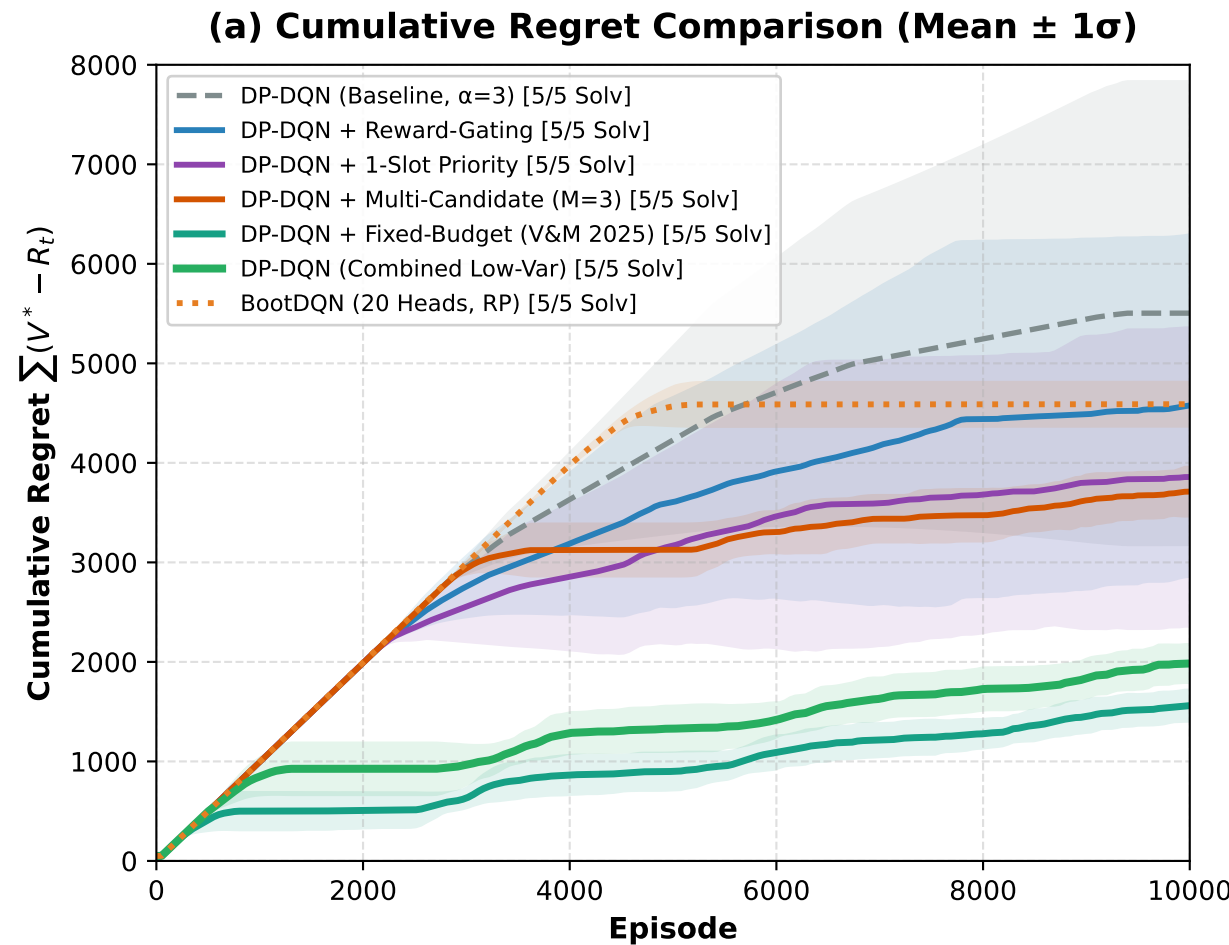


Variance Reduction & Fixed-Budget DP Posterior (Vashishtha & Maillard 2025) on Deep Sea 20×20



(d) Variance Reduction & Efficiency Leaderboard

Method	Nets	Params	Solved	T_learn (Mean $\pm$ Std)	Regret	Cost
DP-DQN (Baseline)	1 Net	8.5k	5/5 (100%)	5564 $\pm$ 2363	5504	15.0 ms
+ Reward-Gating	1 Net	8.5k	5/5 (100%)	4113 $\pm$ 2001	4577	16.5 ms
+ 1-Slot Priority	1 Net	8.5k	5/5 (100%)	3341 $\pm$ 1584	3858	20.9 ms
+ Multi-Candidate	1 Net	8.5k	5/5 (100%)	3152 $\pm$ 245	3711	28.1 ms
+ Fixed-Budget (V&M)	1 Net	8.5k	5/5 (100%)	495 $\pm$ 194	1560	25.2 ms
Combined Low-Var	1 Net	8.5k	5/5 (100%)	926 $\pm$ 266	1984	23.6 ms
BootDQN (20 Heads)	20 Heads	168k	5/5 (100%)	4878 $\pm$ 245	4589	22.5 ms